

CSS37W1 Software Engineering I Project 2026

Phase 4: Software Architecture & System Design

Minutes of the Meeting

Date: 28 April 2026

Time: Meeting concluded at approximately 21 minutes duration

Platform: Online Meeting

Chairperson: Ayanda Dunywa

Minute Taker: Thabiso Besuoftu Andrew Nkambule

Attendance

- Ayanda Dunywa
- Thabiso Besuoftu Andrew Nkambule
- Lloyd Thabiso Khuphe
- Rialivhuwa Kurhula Makhado
- Siphokuhle Wellem

Apology:

- Kanye (Absent)
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1. Opening and Welcome

The meeting commenced with confirmation from members that the meeting could begin. The chairperson welcomed all attendees and introduced the purpose of the meeting, which was to discuss **Phase 4: Software Architecture and System Design** for the CSS37W1 Software Engineering I Project.

2. Discussion of Phase 4 Requirements

The chairperson outlined the objectives and expectations of **Phase 4**, emphasizing that the phase builds on outputs from Phase 3, including:

- Features
- Personas
- User stories
- Requirements mapping

It was highlighted that Phase 4 focuses on creating a **clear technical blueprint** before coding begins to improve:

- System maintainability
- Scalability
- Clarity among team members

The team discussed the importance of:

- Defining an appropriate **system architecture**
 - Identifying system components and interactions
 - Selecting an appropriate **technology stack**
 - Documenting architecture decisions and diagrams for implementation guidance
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3. Task Allocation

The team discussed dividing responsibilities for the completion of Phase 4 deliverables.

Assigned Tasks

- **Task 1:** Assigned to **Ayanda**, who indicated willingness to take responsibility due to the absence of Kanye.
 - Ayanda also indicated collaboration with Kanye upon availability.
 - Team members were encouraged to begin **research related to their assigned tasks** and start implementation preparations.
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4. Architecture Documentation Requirements

The team acknowledged the required project deliverables, which include:

Required Documentation

- docs/architecture/architecture_overview.md
- docs/architecture/system_decomposition.md
- docs/architecture/tech_stack.md

Required Diagrams

The team discussed the need to create and upload architecture visuals into the docs/architecture/diagrams/ folder, including:

- **UML Component Diagram**
- **Data Flow Diagram (Optional)**
- **Deployment Diagram**

Suggested tools for diagram creation included:

- Lucidchart
 - Draw.io
 - Microsoft Visio
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5. Technology Stack and Planning

The importance of selecting and justifying an appropriate technology stack was discussed, including:

- Backend technology
- Frontend framework
- Database
- Hosting platform

The team acknowledged that all design decisions must be clearly justified and aligned with project requirements.

6. GitHub Project Management

Members were reminded to:

- Upload required architecture documents to GitHub
 - Maintain the docs/architecture/ directory structure
 - Upload diagrams into the diagrams/ folder
 - Update the GitHub Project Board with architecture-related tasks
 - Create GitHub Issues where clarification or missing work exists
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7. Suggestions and Additional Input

A suggestion was made by **Thabiso Besufts Andrew Nkambule** regarding the use of planning and diagramming tools for architecture development. It was proposed that

members working on diagrams could make use of planning tools to support system visualization and organization.

8. Next Meeting

The team agreed to hold another meeting on **Friday (Public Holiday)** to discuss **project progress** and review completed work. Final arrangements would be discussed further in the group communication platform.

9. Closure

The chairperson asked if there were any final comments. No additional matters were raised by members.

The meeting was officially adjourned.

Action Items Summary

Task

Task	Responsible Person	Due/Notes
Complete Task 1	Ayanda	Begin immediately
Conduct research for assigned tasks	All Members	Ongoing
Create architecture documentation	Team	Before submission
Create UML, DFD, and Deployment diagrams	Assigned Members	Upload to GitHub
Update GitHub Project Board	Team	Ongoing

Task

Task	Responsible Person	Due/Notes
Attend progress meeting	All Members	Friday

Prepared by:
Thabiso Besuftu Andrew Nkambule

Date Prepared: 28 April 2026